



Houghton Library of the Harvard College Library

To Himself

Author(s): Giacomo Leopardi and Harry Thomas

Source: *Harvard Review*, No. 20 (Spring, 2001), p. 28

Published by: [Harvard Review](#)

Stable URL: <http://www.jstor.org/stable/27568476>

Accessed: 26-12-2015 00:11 UTC

Your use of the JSTOR archive indicates your acceptance of the Terms & Conditions of Use, available at <http://www.jstor.org/page/info/about/policies/terms.jsp>

JSTOR is a not-for-profit service that helps scholars, researchers, and students discover, use, and build upon a wide range of content in a trusted digital archive. We use information technology and tools to increase productivity and facilitate new forms of scholarship. For more information about JSTOR, please contact support@jstor.org.



Houghton Library of the Harvard College Library and Harvard Review are collaborating with JSTOR to digitize, preserve and extend access to *Harvard Review*.

<http://www.jstor.org>

GIACOMO LEOPARDI

Translated from the Italian by Harry Thomas

To Himself

Now, worn-out heart,
you'll rest for good, the last deception dead
which I believed was deathless. Dead.
I'm sure
not just the hope but the desire
for sweet illusions is all gone.
So rest for good.
You've had enough excitement. Nothing's worth
all that you've suffered, nothing's good enough
on the whole earth.
This life is bitter, tedious,
and never any better. The world's shit.
So take your rest.
The one thing that's in store for us
is death. Show your contempt for it
and nature's brutal power, which,
though hidden, governs everything,
the infinite vanity of everything.